HANDBOOK · 2026









ROUND SQUARE INTRASCHOOL CONFERENCE

PURSUIT *of* HAPPINESS

WHEN
17th October

WHERE
The Indian High School

An all-inclusive guidebook to get you started with your journey into Round Square

Message from OUR CORE TEAM

Dear Students,

Welcome to Pursuit of Happiness: Round Square Intraschool Conference 2026!

As members of the core team, we are extremely excited to welcome you to our conference this year. But more than anything, we hope that this conference becomes a place where you can dive deep into discussion, learn about different perspectives, and consider the deeper implications of happiness.

Happiness can mean different things to all of us, and through our discussions, activities, challenges, and conversations, we hope you gain new food for thought about happiness—maybe even understand why we pursue it!

This conference is intended as a place for you to step out of your comfort zone, engage with others, understand the Round Square IDEALS, and develop new skills to take with you. More than anything, this is a conference for you to be you. **Remember, there are no rights or wrongs in happiness, so don't be scared to step up.**

This discussion isn't about getting all the answers to our questions, but about getting closer to them, being curious, and listening to others while sharing our ideas, and most importantly, enjoying the experience.

We hope that this conference leaves you with new friendships, understanding, and the ability to pursue your happiness.

Hope to see you at the conference! *— Core Team*

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PART 01

INTRODUCTION

to Round Square

01

What is ROUND SQUARE?

Round Square is an international community of 250+ schools, across 50 countries and 6 continents. It aims to inspire and draw out students' abilities leading to better self-development, leadership and the skill to assess real-world situations effectively. This is done through various activities such as conferences and student exchange programs within the community.

250+ schools

50 countries

6 continents

> *"There is more in us than we know. If we could be made to see it, perhaps for the rest of our lives we would be unwilling to settle for less.*
>
> — KURT HAHN





HISTORY

1953 · 1966 · 1967

The formation of Round Square was inspired by Kurt Hahn, a German educator. 60 years ago, in 1966, 8 heads of schools across Europe and America came together for a conference celebrating Hahn's birthday. These schools had previously worked together on providing disaster relief to an earthquake in Africa in 1953. The discussion in that conference led to the realization of how much that experience had changed students and its positive impact. This resulted in the decision for the schools to meet again the next year in a 'Hahn Schools Conference', also inviting other schools. This was eventually renamed Round Square in 1967, becoming the organization we know today.

RS Philosophy & PROGRAM OVERVIEW

In order to achieve the goals of Round Square Schools, there are six themes around which programmes are structured — the **IDEALS**.

- **I** Internationalism
- **D** Democracy
- **E** Environmentalism
- **A** Adventure
- **L** Leadership
- **S** Service

THE ROUND SQUARE PHILOSOPHY

DO FIRST, *Describe Later*

The Round Square Philosophy, which promotes its approach to encourage students to learn by doing.



WHY DOES IT MATTER?

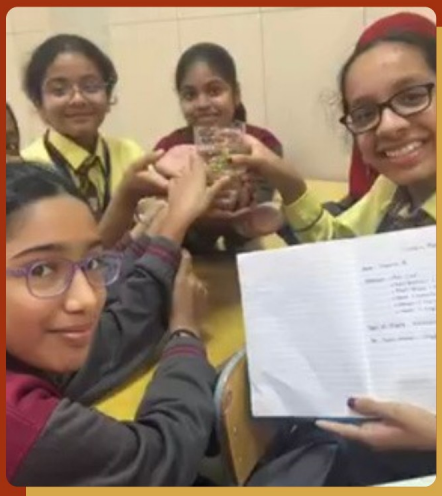
1. **Students:** it gives them experiences that build resilience, independence, and empathy, which are hard to teach in a classroom. Many describe a conference or service trip as a turning point.
2. **Schools:** it provides a ready-made network of partners for exchanges, shared programs, and teacher collaboration.
3. **Universities and employers:** the leadership and service record that comes with it can strengthen a student's profile.

ACTIVITIES OFFERED BY ROUND SQUARE

- Zoom Postcards
- Study Labs
- Worldwide Show and Tell
- Heroes of Discovery
- Collaborations
- Conferences
- Service Projects
- Student Exchange Programs











PART 02

Our CONFERENCE

What is a RS CONFERENCE?

Round Square hosts conferences, which are collaborations of students to discuss real-world issues and work hands-on to support local communities. RS Conferences provide a platform for students to engage in active discussion and broaden their perspectives, all while adhering to the **IDEALS** of Round Square.



THERE ARE THREE TYPES OF ROUND SQUARE CONFERENCES

01

Zoom Postcards

Held online

02

RS Conferences

Face-to-face, held by including only local schools

03

RS International Conferences

Face-to-face, held once a year, including all RS member schools

ELEMENTS OF A RS CONFERENCE

- Keynote Speakers
- Baraza Discussions
- Workshops
- Cultural Experiences
- Team Challenges
- Adventure and Activities
- Debates

WHAT DO YOU LEAVE WITH?

- Wider Perspectives
- Stronger Communication Skills
- New Ideas
- Leadership Opportunities
- Courage to try something new
- An unforgettable experience

OUR THEME

PURSUIT *of* HAPPINESS

Happiness is an emotion, a feeling, and an experience that can have various benefits, including reduced stress, improved relationships, and improved mental health. However, beyond the surface, happiness can mean different things, depending upon the perspective and the context of the situation, making it apt for profound and intense discussion.

In students' lives, the need for happiness can play a key role in influencing their actions, environment, and thoughts, especially as teens. This can cause many students to face dilemmas in their daily life as they navigate between choices testing their morale while they struggle to balance their happiness with their other priorities, potentially leaving them feeling mentally strained.

One question we aim to discuss during this conference is: **Are we happy only because we feel good?** In reality, happiness cannot exist without negative emotions like anger, sadness, and fear. This is because the whole reason we are able to differentiate between our emotions and feelings is due to the contrast in emotions. This means that we can intentionally curate our experiences so that we can feel a greater balance in our mental ecosystems.



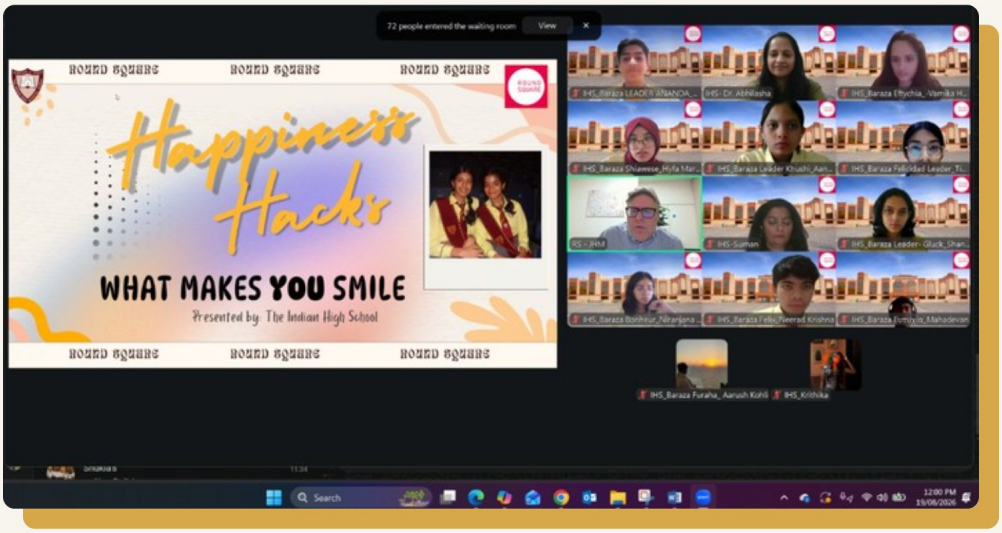


THE BIG QUESTION

Are we happy only because we feel good?

Inspiration behind THIS CONFERENCE

Our previous take on this theme was our online conference that took place on the **19th of August 2026** (extended on 26th August of St. George's Grammar School). During this 60 minute call attended by more than 100 students from around the world, we discussed the different aspects of happiness that allowed us all to understand it. We conducted different activities in our 10 Barazas that were actively controlled by our leaders from Grades 8–10.



Happiness Hacks: What Makes You Smile — our online conference, 19 August 2026

60 min
online call

100+
students worldwide

10
Barazas

8–10
grades of our leaders

WHY IN PERSON

However, due to the conference taking place online, we missed the physical connection, the spontaneity, and the immersion that made us part of a greater bond. This inspired us to create this conference, somewhere tangible where people don't just take home memories or intuitions, *they take away experiences.* Here, we aim to create a place where students don't just discuss or receive insights, but somewhere they experience and in turn realize its depth together.

Junior SCHEDULE

17 OCTOBER

The Indian High School

TIME	ACTIVITY
9:00 – 9:30	Registration
9:30 – 10:30	Opening Ceremony
10:30 – 11:40	Scavenger Hunt
11:40 – 12:40	Baraza Session 1
12:40 – 1:30	Lunch
1:30 – 2:00	Keynote Speaker
2:00 – 2:30	Creative Expression Session
2:30 – 3:00	Photo Sessions
3:00 – 4:30	Baraza Session 2
4:30 – 5:30	Team Dance
5:45	Dispersal

Intermediate & Senior SCHEDULE

17 OCTOBER

The Indian High School

TIME	ACTIVITY
9:00 – 9:30	Registration
9:30 – 10:30	Opening Ceremony
10:30 – 12:40	Baraza Session 1
12:40 – 1:30	Lunch
1:30 – 2:00	Keynote Speaker
2:00 – 2:30	Creative Expression Session
2:30 – 3:00	Photo Session
3:00 – 4:30	Baraza Session 2
4:30 – 5:30	Team Dance & Closing Ceremony
5:45	Dispersal

Additional INFORMATION

ORGANIZING TEAM

Fri 9 Oct

All students who wish to be part of the Organizing Team must fill out the form below by Friday 9th October, at 11:59 pm.

DELEGATE APPLICATIONS

Mon 12 Oct

Delegate Applications for the Conference will be sent out on Monday, 12th October.

PARTICIPATION

Free of cost

This conference will be free of cost, with no extra delegate fees to be paid for participation.

FORM https://forms.cloud.microsoft/Pages/ResponsePage.aspx?id=KqwhzDIhXkeAqvuIYaXkVxYd0LC8_jpHl1f360USBgFUREtOUlVIMFoySVROTDJDSzJOTkg3NUMwTi4u

GOOD TO KNOW

Participants will not be provided transport on the day of the conference and are requested to bring their own tiffin boxes, as lunch is not being provided.

The dress code for this conference is **strict formals**, and students are required to bring their ID card along with them. Lack of ID card will result in the student not being allowed to enter the campus.

Parents are also encouraged to join this conference as delegates. They will have separate baraza discussions and activities throughout the day.

There will be a delegate orientation next week in the auditorium. Further details will be addressed later.

ANY OTHER QUERIES
roundsquareteam.ihs@gmail.com

MORE ABOUT ROUND SQUARE
www.roundsquare.org